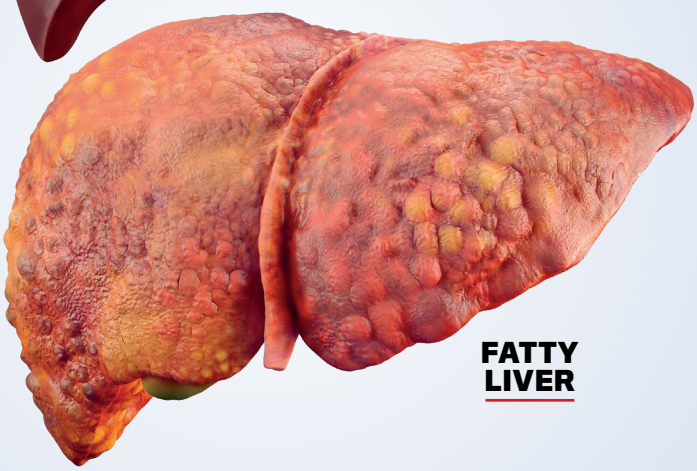
BURDEN OF NAFLD IN INDIA

38% ADULTS IN INDIA HAVE NAFLD

35% OF CHILDREN HAVE IT – A SHOCKING PREVALENCE



NORMAL LIVER



FATTY LIVER

TYPES OF NAFLD

- **Simple fatty liver:** Also called steatosis, it is the first sign of fat accumulation, which can be reversed
- **NASH:** Non-alcoholic steatohepatitis (NASH) occurs when the liver starts to get inflamed, responding to overaccumulation of fat cells inside or around it. At this stage, it is reversible
- **Fibrosis:** The gradual process of liver cells getting destroyed. Thin bands of scar tissues start to build up, reducing blood flow through the liver, and limiting its access to oxygen and nutrients
- **Cirrhosis:** Left untreated, the liver can get severe, permanent scarring. It then does not have enough healthy cells and can no longer regenerate. Eventually, it may lead to liver failure and require transplant, without which it can prove fatal

WHAT CAUSES NAFLD?

The mere consumption of fat does not cause NAFLD. An unbalanced diet, poor exercise, poor sleep and even stress can cause it

OBESITY: The most common risk factor, particularly central obesity found in 84% of Indian patients with NAFLD. But you don't always have to be overweight to have NAFLD, about 10-15% of afflicted Indians are lean with normal BMI

HIGH-CALORIE DIET: A diet high in starch, sweets, processed food

HYPERTENSION: High blood pressure can contribute to systemic inflammation, a common cause of NAFLD

HIGH TRIGLYCERIDES: Triglycerides are fat molecules, which often accumulate in the liver–the primary characteristic of NAFLD

DIABETES: Insulin resistance and NAFLD are linked to one another

GENETIC PREDISPOSITION: There is a genetic component to risk but also to other metabolic diseases, including those with family history of obesity, high BP and diabetes

SLEEP APNEA: It deprives the body of oxygen and triggers inflammation, oxidative stress, and metabolic dysregulation in the liver which can then lead to fat accumulation and potential liver damage

CERTAIN MEDICATIONS: Medicines such as Corticosteroids, Tamoxifen, Amiodarone, antidepressants and Methotrexate run the risk of causing the body to store fat improperly, or can worsen existing fatty liver disease

TREATMENTS

- **WEIGHT LOSS:** Typically, losing 10% of your body weight or more is recommended
- **ANTI-FIBROTIC DRUGS:** These can reverse fibrosis though not cirrhosis
- **CELL AND GENE THERAPY:** The first can help regenerate damaged liver tissue, the second can modify genetic liver defects
- **LIVER TRANSPLANT:** This is the last option once a liver is damaged. Currently, the one-year survival rate of a liver transplant is more than 90 per cent in India